

The Optimal Number of Naps

Findings from a subject who slept through the study

Ada Lovelace ^{1,2}, Charles Babbage ²

¹ Institute for Applied Statistics · ² Analytical Society

March 2026

The problem

Nobody agrees on how many naps a day is correct. We asked the only expert on the subject and he fell asleep during the question.

- Recruit one dog.
- Watch him for a week.
- Write down every time he stops moving.

The instrument

Two ways to count a nap

Strict

- Eyes fully closed.
- Tail completely still.
- Survives one doorbell.

Generous

- Eyes mostly closed.
- Tail negotiable.
- He looks comfortable, so it counts.

One pass of the counter

```
def count_naps(dog, hours):  
    return [h for h in hours  
            if dog.is_horizontal(h)]
```

Caveat

Sitting upright with both eyes closed remains contested.

In practice

A well-behaved subject

The method requires a subject who stays put. This one is world class.



What it costs him

Naps	Hours
3	4.1
11	9.8

asleep

stirring

doorbell